

Getting gas

Gas is only found in certain places. To get it to where it is needed, it is fed through very long pipes, or changed into liquid and put in special ships.



Making glass

Glass is made by melting together sand, soda ash, and ground limestone. People blow or machine press the red-hot mineral mixture into different shapes that set hard and clear as the glass cools.

Glass bottles are shaped from molten glass.

Extracting metals

Most metals are found underground as minerals in rocks called ores. Giant machines dig up the ore. The metal is extracted, or taken out, from the ore using heat.



Metal variety

Different metal resources have different uses.



Aluminium is a soft metal used to make cans, aircraft, and car bodies.



Gold is rare and looks attractive, so it is often used to make jewellery.



Iron is strong. It is used to make steel for ships, buildings, and pylons.



Copper conducts electricity and is used to make electrical wires.

Creating concrete

Concrete is an important building material. It is a mixture of sand, gravel, cement, and water. All these ingredients are found in the ground.

